

5 Wrong Track Milkha Singh Turns Down Arjuna Award

In an interview to INDIA TODAY in September 2001, the Flying Sikh had said, "the prestigious award has been reduced to a *tamasha*". More dirt was dug up. From the unappreciated Kanwaljit Sandhu, the first Indian woman to win an international athletics gold, to the moving plight of Makhan Singh, the only one to break Milkha's record.



SUMET INDER SINGH

6 Weighed Trouble Pratima Tests Positive for Dope at Athens

A shocked country looked on as Pratima Kumari was banned from the event and for life at the Athens Olympics 2004, for testing positive for drugs. While she blamed her coaches, they pointed at her personal trainers and even on her habit of turning up inebriated for training. Since 2004, no less than 113 Indian athletes have been accused of doping. INDIA TODAY reported in September 2004 that the International Weightlifting Federation president had threatened to suspend the Weightlifting Federation of India, saying: "These positive cases have demolished your country's prestige."



AFP



AFP

7 Turf Wars Chappell vs Ganguly

It became the clash of the titans, which divided the entire cricket fraternity. A leaked e-mail to the BCCI exposed coach Greg Chappell's stance on skipper Sourav Ganguly in which he had doubted the latter's behaviour, physical form and team spirit. Ganguly accused the coach of pitting players against one another. The result: "Chuck a pebble into the team bus and the chances of it striking a conflicted player are high," reported INDIA TODAY in October 2005.

8 Playing her Ace Sania's Fatwa Controversy

After storming the international tennis circuit in 2003, Sania Mirza has never been left alone. Fatwas were issued against her for her clothes to which she replied, "Some say Muslim girls shouldn't wear mini-skirts, others say I've made the community proud. I hope God forgives me... but you have to do what you have to do." (INDIA TODAY, January 2005). Sometimes she bent to the furore and refused to play, but mostly, Mirza just let her racquet do the talking.

PRATIMA TESTING POSITIVE FOR DOPE LED TO MANY RED FACES AND HER BEING BANNED FOR LIFE.